

youkined from <https://github.com/Nicicalu/OST-CN2-Spik>

OSPF (IGP)
 Uses Cost Multi-Path (ECMP) load balancing, fast convergence, widely used.
 Equal IP Port 89 on L3. Uses 224.0.0.5 (all routers), 224.0.0.6 (all DR,BDR)
DR Election: Highest Ifr prio → If tie, highest Router ID. Priority 0 = ineligible for DR/BDR. No preemption. BDR = same rules, second best candidate
Virtual links: Cannot go through more than one stub area, can only run through standard non-backbone areas. (eg. not over stubby areas)

ROUTER OPERATION

- Establish neighbor adjacencies and exchange LSAs
- Build the Link-State Database (LSDB)
- Run Dijkstra's SPF algorithm:
 - Intra-area change: SPF recalculation
 - Inter-area change: No SPF needed → ABR handles updates
- Build the routing table from SPF results

ROUTE TYPES

O: Intra-area: Local area → Local area. Type 1 and 2 LSAs
 O: Intra-area: Local area → Neighboring area. Via LSA 3 through backbone
 O E1 or O E2: External: Local area → External (eg. BGP), from ASBR
 O E1: Cost = internal + external metrics
 O E2: Cost = external metrics. Default external route for OSPF
Cost calculation: Reference Bandwidth/(def=100 Mbps)/Interface Bandwidth

AREAS

AS Split into areas with 32-bit Area ID (e.g., 0.0.0.0 = Area 0)
Backbone Area (Area 0): Core of the OSPF domain, must connect to all other areas (directly/virtual links), must be contiguous (no disjointed segments), should not contain end-user networks, summarizes topology of other areas
Non-Backbone Areas: Connect end users and local resources, All inter-area traffic must transit the backbone

ROUTER TYPES

Area Border Router (ABR): Connects two or more OSPF areas, must have 1 interface in backbone, 1 OSPF DB per Area
Internal Router (IR): All interfaces belong to the same area (non-backbone)
Backbone Router (BR): At least one interface in Area 0, Includes ABRs and routers internal to the backbone

AS Boundary Router (ASBR): Connects to external AS/Network (e.g., BGP), Advertises external routes into OSPF, can be in backbone or non-backbone

DESIGN RULES

Rule 1: Backbone (Area 0) must be contiguous → no partitions allowed
Rule 2: Every non-backbone area must connect to Area 0

LINK STATE ADVERTISEMENT (LSA) TYPES

- Router-LSA:** All routers list directly connected links (so all outgoing interfaces with state and cost) (intra-area)
- Network-LSA:** DR lists all routers and DR in broadcast/multi-access network (intra-area)
- Summary-LSA:** ABR advertises networks from other areas, flooded in all areas that are not "totally stubby" (inter-area)
- ASBR-Summary:** ABR advertises path to ASBRs, ASBR sends Type 1 + external bit, ABR converts to Type 4 and floods (inter-area)
- AS-External-LSA:** ASBR/ABR advertises external routes (e.g., BGP); flooded to all non-stub areas → only normal areas (inter-area)
- NSAA External:** Like Type 5 but inside NSAA. Converted to Type 7 by ABR. Shown in routing table as [O N1 or O N2]

AREA TYPES (ALLOWED LSA TYPES)

Stubby = Blocks external LSA [No 5], Totally = Blocks inter-area LSA [No 3/4]
 Default: (e.g., 0.0.0.0) from ABR [DR ABR], Cannot contain ASBR [No ASBR]
Standard (1,2,3,4,5): Normal
Stub Area (1,2,3): [No 4/5] [DR ABR] [No ASBR]
Totally Stubby Area (1,2): [No 3/4/5] [DR ABR] [No ASBR]
Not-So-Stubby Area (1,2,3,7): [No 4/5], no DR, allows 1 ASBR [LSA 7 → 5]
 Totally NSAA (1,2,7): [No 3/4/5] [DR ABR] [LSA 7 → 5]

PACKET TYPES

- Hello:** Usually Multicast. Discover, maintain, and verify neighbors. Forms adjacencies. Election of DR/BDR in broadcast networks. Contains network mask (sending routers' IF), Hello interval (p2p broadcast: def=10s), Options, Priority (election), Router dead interval (def=40s), DR/BDR IP, Neighbors.
- Database Description (DBD/DD):** Unicast. Exchange summaries of LSAs during adjacency formation (headers only). Contains Ifr Max. MTU, Options, I/M/M/BS bits (Initial, More, Master-slave bit), DD Seq. Num., LSA Header
- Link State Request (LSR):** Unicast. Request specific LSAs. Contains Link State Type (router/net), Link State ID, Advertising Router (sender address)
- Link State Update (LSU):** Multi/Unicast. Implicit ack. Flood new/updated LSAs. Answer to LSR (unicast). Contains Nr. of LSAs, full LSAs information.
- Link State Acknowledgment (LSAck):** Multi/Unicast. Explicit ack. Confirms receipt of LSAs for reliable flooding. Acks may be grouped together.

SUB-PROTOCOLS

Hello Protocol: Neighbor discovery. Parameter negotiation. Maintain logical adjacencies on P2P, P2MP, virtual links. Election DR/BDR on broadcast and NBMA networks. Continuously sends hello packets to maintain bidirectional connectivity, failure to receive = neighbor down (RouterDeadInterval)
Database Sync Protocol: Sync LSDB using DBD packets.

NEIGHBOR STATES

Down: Initial state, no Hello packets exchanged or after RouterDeadInterval Int. Received Hello packet from neighbor but without its own Router ID yet
2-Way: Seen its own Router ID. DR/BDR election is taking place in NBMA
ExStart: (DBD) Bi-dir comm; highest Router-ID=master. Determine init Seq Nr
Exchange: Exchange of DBD packets (LSA headers).
Loading: Missing LSAs are requested. (LSRLSU)
Full: Databases fully synchronized. Normal operating state

OSPF ROUTING AND ECMP

- Each router runs Dijkstra per area; link cost = Metric from LSA1 (865535)
- Perfer more specific match (CIDR), else O > O > A > E1 > N1 > E2 > N2
- Routes added to RIB/FIB based on computed next hops
- ECMP: Modified Dijkstra supports Equal-Cost Multi-Path if multiple paths have same cost → routes added with multiple next-hops for load balancing

IS-IS (IGP)

Widely used by ISPs, Fast convergence, ECMP, Extendable
 ES: End-host devices are called End Systems (ES)
 IS: Routers are called Intermediate Systems (IS)

CONNECTIONLESS NETWORK SERVICES (CLNS)

CLNS: ISO Layer 3 datagram service; supports CLNP, ES-IS, IS-IS
CLNP: Connectionless Network Protocol, similar to IP, used in ISO stack
IS-IS: host → router discovery protocol
IS-IS: router ↔ router. Link-state routing protocol
Integrated IS-IS: Allows IP routing with IS-IS

NETWORK SERVICE ACCESS POINT (NSAP)

Variable in length (up to 20 bytes), Identifies 49.001.1.0000.0000.0003.00 node, not Ifr. Example from IP: 192.168.1.24 Area ID (L1) System ID (RIB) NSRL
 → 49.0001.1921.6808.1024.08

Network Entity Type (NET): Unique router identifier. NSEL=0. Starts with 49
Authority & Format identifier (AFI): NSAP format-authority that assigned it
Initial Domain Identifier (IDI): Variable len, identifies administrative domain
Domain Specific Part Format identifier (DFI): Specifies format

Domain Specific Part (DSP): Var len, contains hierarchical structure of addr
NSEL (N-Selector): always 0n for routers (1b)
System ID: Unique per router (often based on Io-IP/MAC) (6b)
Area ID: Used for routing hierarchy (like OSPF areas) (AFI+DI+DSP)

PACKET TYPES (ALL IN L1 OR L2)

All PDUs contain Header with shared common fields + specific routing-related information (Type, Length and Value (TLV)) used to extend protocol
IIH (Hello): Build/maintain adjacencies. Includes system ID, holding time, prio
Functions: discover, build, maintain
Interval: 10s (default); DIS sends every 3.3s on LANs
Multiplier: Missed Hello limit → Holdtime = Interval × Multiplier(def=3)
Multicast: [L1 01-80-c2-00-00-14] [L2 01-80-c2-00-00-15]
LSP (Link State PDU): Contains topology info including prefixes with costs; unicast on p2p or flooded throughout the area (OSPF: LSA Type 1)
Complete SNRP: Sent by DIS; lists all known LSPs (OSPF: DBD)
PSNP (Partial SNRP): Used to request missing or acknowledge received LSPs

ROUTER TYPES

L1 Router: Within one area; all have same LSPDB. No inter-area routing
L2 Router: Backbone router; all have same LSPDB. Routes between areas
L1/L2 Router: Acts as both; separates LSPDBs, redistributes between levels

ADJACENCIES

Backbone must be contiguous: L1 ↔ L1-L2 ↔ L2
 L1: Are addresses match unless configured otherwise
 L2: Allside L1, unless router is L1 only, areas must not match

POINT-TO-POINT (NO DIS)

Initialized by receipt of IS-Hs, exchange p2p IIHs padded to MTU
CSPN: Sent once at adjacency startup
LSP: Advertises topology changes (link-state info)
PSNP: Acknowledges received LSPs or requests missing ones

BROADCAST/MULTI-ACCESS (DIS REQUIRED)

Not triggered by IS-Hs, instead broadcast IIHs with all neighbors MAC's
Designated Intermediate System (DIS): Create, update pseudonode LSPs.
 Flood LSPs. Similar to DR in OSPF. No backup DIS.
DIS Election: Highest priority (0-127) (Cisco def=64) = Highest SNPA (MAC)
Preemption: Enabled → higher prio router automatically takes over DIS Role
Pseudonode: Carried out by DIS. Multiaccess links. Separate for L1/L2
Passive interfaces: Advertise network prefixes without adjacency forming

PATH SELECTION

Default interface metric = 10. **Lower Metric better:** L1 intra-area > L2 intra-area > Leaked L2 → L1 (internal metric) > L1 external (external metric) > L2 external (external metric) > Leaked L2 → L1 (external metric)

LEVEL 1 ROUTING

Intra-area routing only (L1 Area like OSPF Totally Stubby Area)
 L1 routers install a default route to nearest L1-L2 for inter-area traffic
L1-L2: Do not advertise L2 routes into L1 area (unless route leaking active)
L1-L2: Set Attached bit to signal L2 connectivity to backbone
Distribution Bit: Set to 1 on L2 → L1; blocks re-advertisement L1 → L2.
Route-Leaking: injects a more specific route into L1 to improve routing

LEVEL 2 ROUTING

Routing between areas (inter-area)
 L1-L2 routers inject L1 routes into L2 topology
 L1 routes are redistributed into L2 with L1 metric preserved in L2 LSP

IS-IS VS OSPF

Feature	IS-IS	OSPF
Layer	L2 (CLNS)	L3 (IP, proto 89)
Encapsulation	No IP, uses TLVs	IP packets
Hello Type	IIH	Hello packet
Area Model	L1/L2	Backbone + Areas
Metric	Cost (default 10)	Cost (bandwidth)
Router ID	System ID (6B)	32-bit Router ID
Adj. Types	L1, L2, L1/L2	DR/BDR, P2P
LSDB	Per level (L1/L2)	Per area
Scaling	Large-scale ISP core	Enterprise/campus
Routing Info	TLVs (flexible)	Fixed LSA types
Type	Link-State	Link-State
Shortest Path calculation	Dijkstra	Dijkstra

BGP (EGP)

Path-vector routing protocol. Stable, flexible, scalable. Based on TCP
IGBP
 Routers in same AS, AD=200, more trusted (lower security overhead). AS-Path and Next-hop not modified

SCALABILITY

IGBP does not re-advertise routes between iBGP peers → full mesh required (caused no loop prevention)
 Session count = $n \cdot (n-1) / 2$ (e.g., 5 routers = 10 sessions, 10 = 45)

ROUTE REFLECTORS (RR)

Solves iBGP full-mesh scaling by allowing selective route reflection. Clients only peer with RR, unaware they're clients. Only the RR needs special config. From non-client, RR advertises to clients only
 From client, RR advertises to all clients + non-clients
 From eBGP peer, RR advertises to all clients + non-clients

EBGP

Routers in different ASes, AD=20, stricter policy enforcement. Prepends ASN to AS-Path, modifies next-hop IP. Fails if own ASN in AS-Path. TTL=1
AS-Override: Allows reuse of same ASN across different customer sites (e.g., Swisscom); rewrites ASN to avoid loop detection

CONFIG

next-hop-self fixing iBGP: neighbor (neighbor IP) next-hop-self (overriding)
AUTONOMOUS SYSTEM NUMBERS (ASN)

- Unique ID for each AS; required for Internet routing with BGP
- Private: [Legacy 16-bit 64512-65535] [32-bit 4200000000-4294967294]

PEERING / NEIGHBORS

- Two routers with a BGP TCP session (port 179) are called peers/neighbors
- Each BGP router is a **BGP speaker**
- Supports CIDR, route aggregation; decisions based on policies/rules

PATH ATTRIBUTES

Used for route control and policy enforcement
Well-known mandatory: Always present (e.g., AS-Path, Origin, Next Hop)
Well-known discretionary: Optional but recognized by all (e.g., Local Pref)
Optional transitive: Passed between ASes (e.g., Community, Aggregator)
Optional non-transitive: Not passed across ASes (e.g., MED, Weight)
NLRI: Routing table info: prefix, prefix length, and associated path attributes

MESSAGES

OPEN: Establishes session; includes version, ASN, Hold Time, BGP Identifier, optional params. **Hold Time:** Heartbeat in seconds (Cisco def=180s), reset by KEEPALIVE/UPDATE; 0 = session down. **BGP Identifier:** 32-bit router ID, manually set or highest loopback/active IP; used for loop prevention
KEEPALIVE: Sent every 1/3 of Hold time; ensures neighbor liveness
UPDATE: Advertises new routes, withdraws old ones, or both; includes NLRI (prefix + path attributes); can act as KEEPALIVE
NOTIFICATION: Sent on session error (e.g. hold timer expired); terminates session immediately

NETWORK STATEMENTS

Advertise a specific network prefix to BGP peers (only the best is advertised, even if multiple exist). Must exist in the RIB so that it's imported in BGP table
Configure: next-hop: 0.0.0.0, origin attribute: i, weight: 32768 (Cisco)
Static/RP: next-hop: NH in RIB, MED: IGP metric, rest same as above

BEST PATH CALCULATION

- BGP maintains all received paths per prefix but advertises only the best one
- Best path is installed in RIB, recalculated on:
 - Next-hop reachability change
 - Interface failure to eBGP peer
 - Redistribution change
 - New/withdrawn path received
- Influence:
 - Outbound BGP policy → inbound traffic behavior
 - Inbound BGP policy → outbound traffic behavior

BEST PATH SELECTION (NO DIS):

- Prefer highest **Weight** (Cisco-specific, local to router)
- Prefer highest **Local Preference** (global within AS)
- Prefer routes **originated by the router** (only small i path, NH 0.0.0.0)
- Prefer **shorter AS path** (only length is compared)
- Prefer **lowest origin type** (IGP < EGP < incomplete (I on origin))
- Prefer **lowest MED** (Multi-Exit Discriminator) (also called metric)
- Prefer **external (EBGP) over internal (IBGP)**
- For iBGP: prefer path with **lowest IGP metric** to next-hop
- For eBGP: Prefer **lowest** (more stable) path
- Prefer **lowest BGP router ID**
- Prefer path from **lowest neighbor IP** address

ROUTE FILTERING

- Filters control which routes are received/advertised
- Used for security, traffic shaping, memory optimization
- Tools: **prefix-list** (IP), **filter-list** (AS-path), **route-map** (flexible match/set)

COMMUNITIES

32b optional, transitive tag (e.g. ASN: valUe, 65000:100). Used to mark routes for policy control across ASes. Can be added, modified, or removed at each hop

PEERING VS. TRANSIT

Transit: ISP provides full reachability (paid relationship)
Peering: ISP exchanges selected routes; equal relationship, usually unpaid
AS Path Filtering: to avoid getting transit: ip as-path access-list 10 permit * \$

INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT (IXP)

- Facility where networks exchange traffic via BGP peering
- Reduces transit costs, latency, and offloads upstream links

PUBLIC PEERING

- Members peer via shared switch fabric and a **route server**
- Route server distributes routes but stays out of data path (NEXT_HOP unchanged)
- Minimal policy control; one BGP session to route server
- Simplified setup (one legal contract)

PRIVATE PEERING

- Direct BGP sessions between two parties (1:1)
- May use public or private interconnects
- Full policy control per neighbor
- Requires one session and legal contract per peer

EXAMPLES: Equinix, SwissIX (non-profit)

ENTERPRISE CONNECTIVITY OPTIONS

Single/Dual: denotes how many links there are
Multi-Homed-/Homed: denotes how many ISPs are connected
Single-Homed: One ISP, one link (BGP or static). Simple but no redundancy
Dual-Homed: One ISP, two links (routers). Redundancy within same provider
Multihomed: Multiple ISPs; improved redundancy and routing control, but avoid being a transit – advertise only customer-owned prefixes
Dual-Multihomed: Multihomed, but two links per ISP. Most redundancy

TRAFFIC ENGINEERING (TE) - INBOUND VS OUTBOUND

Local Pref: [Out] [highest T] Lower local pref on backup path
MED: [IN] [lowest T] Higher MED on backup path
AS-Path: [Prepending: IN] [shortest T] Add multiple own ASN on backup path
TE Limitation: AS controls (OUT), [IN] control limited - ISPs

TE with Aggregate: Prefer primary ISP with summarized routes; advertise specific prefixes on backup for failover
RPKI - RESOURCE PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE
 Framework to validate that a prefix is legitimately originated by a specific ASN
 Prevents route hijacking and accidental mis-originations (route leaks)
 RPKI validates origin only – not the AS-path

KEY COMPONENTS

Trust Anchors (TAs): Root CAs of the 5 RIRs; issue certs for resource holders
ROA – Route Origin Authorization: Digitally signed object that authorizes ASN to announce a prefix (contains AS, prefix that AS can originate, max prefix length)
RPKI Validators: Software that downloads, verifies, and stores Validated ROA Payloads (VRPs)

RPKI VALIDATION STATES

Valid: Prefix + ASN match ROA
Invalid: Prefix found, but ASN mismatch or prefix too long
Not Found / Unknown: No matching ROA

VALIDATOR DETAILS

- Use TALS (Trust Anchor Locators) to fetch data from RIRs
- Validate cryptographic signatures (via X.509 certs with RFC 3779)
- Outputs VRPs; invalid objects are discarded
- Update frequency: >>24h (recommended), ~30-60min (practice)
- RRDP (RFC 8182) replacing rsync (uses HTTPS)

MONITORING

Event tracking, BGP hijack detection, Route leak detection, RPKI status check, Reachability tracking, AS path change tracking, AS path visualization

NETWORK DESIGN

Pillars: Scalability, Speed, Availability, Security, Manageability → overall Cost

AVAILABILITY CONCEPTS (MOST IMPORTANT REQUIREMENT)

MTBF: Mean Time Between Failures, **MTTR:** Mean Time to Repair

$A = \frac{MTBF}{MTBF + MTTR}$ MTBF combined: $(\sum_{n=1}^N \frac{1}{MTBF_n})^{-1}$ parallel:
 $\frac{1}{A} = \frac{MTBF}{MTBF + MTTR}$
 Lower MTTR + higher MTBF = more availability

REDUNDANCY

- Adds reliability, decreases MTBF but increases MTTR and complexity
- Balance: resilience vs. manageability

Backup Paths: Duplicate devices/links on primary path, build extra links for redundancy, consider backup link capacity, consider failover speed
Load Balancing: ECMP, EtherChannel, Port-Channel

HIERARCHICAL DESIGN

Access: Connect end devices, high port count, port security, L2, QoS marking
Distribution: L3, policy control, HSRP/VRP, loop protection, small fault domain

Core: High-speed backbone, L3 only, no policy, scalable/redundant, no security

Collapsed Core: Combines Core + Distribution (small/medium networks)

FLAT DESIGN

- Any-to-any; small networks, MPLS/LAN setups
- Lacks scalability and control

FABRIC DESIGN

Modern design using Underlay/Overlay
Underlay: transport (e.g., IP, MPLS)
Overlay: logical virtual topology (e.g., EVPN)

ENTERPRISE CAMPUS

- 100s/1000s of users, multiple buildings, one physical location
- Multiple interconnected LANs, connected via Ethernet and Wireless

FHRP - FIRST HOP REDUNDANCY PROTOCOLS

- Ensures default gateway is always reachable, PCs can only have one
- Enables fast failover during router failure

VRPP - Virtual Router Redundancy Protocol (Multivendor): Shared virtual IP, real MACs per router, Master router handles forwarding

HSRP - Hot Standby Router Protocol (Cisco): Shared virtual IP + virtual MAC, One active, others in standby → faster

GLBP - Gateway Load Balancing Protocol (Cisco): Load balancing + redundancy, Shared virtual IP + multiple virtual MACs, Roles: AVG: Answers ARP and sends virtual MAC addresses of AVFs AVF: Forward traffic

DATA CENTER DESIGNS

Tor - Top of Rack: switches per rack, less cabling, easy expansions/exchanges per rack, scalable glass fiber, ideal for high service density (full racks). But more switches, more ports, more L2 Srv-2-Srv traffic, more STP to be managed

Eor - End of Row: 1 switch per row, less switches, higher utilization of ports, switches all at one place, better L2 availability between racks. But more cabling

TRAFFIC DIRECTIONS

North-South: Between external networks (client-server, in/out DC)
East-West: Within DC (e.g., server-server, storage)

THREE-TIER DC

- Access – Aggregation – Core (like Hierarchical)
- Optimized for North-South traffic
- Not ideal for East-West communication

LEAF-SPINE ARCHITECTURE

- Two-tier. Leaf switches (access) connect to Spines (core)
- High performance, low latency
- Scalable, ideal for East-West traffic

MULTICAST

Use-cases 1-to-Many: Streaming, software updates, music-on-hold
Use-cases Many-to-Many: Gaming, VR, stock data, chat group
Benefits: Efficient bandwidth, lower server/CPU load, no redundancy, supports multiport apps
Properties: UDP-based (no delivery guarantee, congestion control, or order-ing) Apps must handle drops, duplicates, out-of-order packets
Source: Sends to group IP; doesn't need to join
Receiver: Must explicitly join group to receive traffic

MULTICAST ADDRESS RANGES

224.0.0.0 – 224.0.0.255: Link-local, TTL = 1 (not forwarded by

TODO'S
OSPF
– passive interfaces
– flooding
– O N1 / O N2 routes
– route summarization
– synchronizing the Isdb
IS-IS
– ES-IS, IS-IS: details
– adjacencies
– route leaking
– summarization
BGP
– comparison to IGP
– Multihop sessions
– NLRI
– Aggregate impact (TE)
– rework
– Best path calculation
TODO:
notes 37+